

NorthStar

Strategic Risk Intelligence Platform

Project Blueprint

Vision Mapping

Product Architecture

Advisor-Focused Risk Visualization

Purpose

Transform abstract financial risks into clear, visual, emotionally understandable future-outcome models for advisor-client conversations.

1. Executive Overview

NorthStar is a risk-management visualization and advisory intelligence platform for financial advisors, insurance advisors, disability insurance specialists, and risk-planning professionals. It is designed to help clients understand the financial consequences of high-impact disruption events before specific products are introduced.

Positioning statement

NorthStar is not a full financial planning suite. It is a focused risk-visualization layer that makes vulnerability visible, quantifiable, and easier for clients to understand.



2. Product Thesis

Financial planning contains budgeting, wealth management, investment strategy, risk management, estate planning, and other disciplines. NorthStar deliberately focuses on risk management - especially the financial impact of losing income due to death, disability, unemployment, lawsuits, or liability events.

The product's central operating principle is: **show the gap before selling the solution**. The advisor first helps the client see the financial exposure. Product depth, policy design, underwriting, carrier selection, and implementation come later.

3. Current MVP Scope

Input Advisor enters client profile data, income, existing coverage, assumptions, and risk category inputs.	Output NorthStar generates visual models that show the risk exposure, coverage offset, and remaining protection gap.
Interaction Tabs may eventually become interactive, but the immediate product should stay simple: clean input, credible model, readable output.	Use Case Advisor uses the outputs during client meetings to simplify abstract risk and make the need easier to conceptualize.

4. Core Risk Modules

The platform should be organized by risk category. Each module should answer a specific client-facing question and produce a small set of focused visuals.

Module	Client Question	Recommended Outputs
Life Insurance	If I die prematurely, what income and financial support disappears for my family?	Income replacement gap; existing group coverage offset; private coverage need; survivor financial timeline.
Disability Insurance	If I cannot work due to illness or injury, how does my financial plan change?	Income collapse curve; reserve depletion timeline; employer benefit offset; partial vs total disability scenarios; uncovered income gap.
Unemployment	How long can I sustain my financial plan after job loss?	Emergency reserve runway; burn-rate model; recovery timeline; monthly shortfall visualization.
Liability / Lawsuit	What assets or future earnings are exposed if I face a lawsuit?	Asset exposure map; umbrella coverage gap; wealth erosion scenario; protection adequacy summary.

5. Life Insurance Module

The life insurance tab is the simplest proof-of-concept module. It uses income and trajectory assumptions to show the financial gap created by premature death. Existing employer or group life insurance fills part of the gap, but usually leaves a substantial remaining exposure that private life insurance may address.

Inputs

Income, age, family structure, dependents, debt, employer/group life insurance, private coverage, desired income replacement period.

Outputs

Future income lost, coverage offset, remaining protection need, survivor cash-flow gap, and simplified family financial impact.

6. Disability Insurance Module - Strategic Core

Disability Insurance should become the most strategically important module. It is harder for clients to conceptualize than life insurance because the person is still alive, expenses continue, income may be partially or totally disrupted, and the duration is uncertain.

Core DI thesis

Your ability to earn income is usually your largest financial asset. Disability risk is the risk that this asset becomes impaired, temporarily or permanently.

Recommended DI Visual Outputs

Income Collapse Curve

Compares expected income trajectory against disabled-income trajectory over time.

Financial Survival Timeline

Shows how long emergency reserves and available benefits sustain the household.

Protection Gap Stack

Stacks employer DI, savings, spouse income, state benefits, and remaining uncovered gap.

Partial vs Total Scenario

Shows how different disability severity levels change the income replacement need.

Lifestyle Compression Model

Displays spending cuts required to remain solvent after income loss.

Recovery Path Comparison

Compares short-term disability, long-term disability, and permanent-disability paths.

7. Product Experience Principles

- Presentation-first: every output should work in a live advisor-client meeting.
- Minimal input burden: collect only the data needed to produce a useful risk visualization.
- High clarity: avoid spreadsheet-heavy views when the goal is client comprehension.
- Scenario-based: frame outputs as illustrative planning scenarios, not guarantees.
- Advisor-controlled: the advisor interprets and contextualizes the output for the client.
- Modular: each risk tab should stand alone but share a consistent visual language.

8. Recommended Product Architecture

Layer	Purpose	Early Recommendation
Frontend	Advisor-facing input forms, tabs, charts, and printable outputs.	React or Next.js with a chart library such as Recharts or D3 for custom visuals.
Model Logic	Risk formulas, assumptions, gap calculations, and scenario rules.	Keep formulas transparent and editable before adding AI-generated interpretation.
Data Layer	Stores client scenarios, advisor sessions, templates, and saved reports.	Start lightweight. Avoid enterprise complexity until workflows are validated.
AI Layer	Explains outputs and produces client-friendly summaries.	Use AI for explanation, not regulated advice or deterministic product recommendations.

9. Vision Map

Stage 1	Risk Visualization MVP	Input client data and generate clear, static risk visuals for life insurance and initial modules.
Stage 2	Advisor Presentation Engine	Saved scenarios, client-ready summaries, downloadable reports, and meeting-friendly outputs.
Stage 3	Interactive Scenario Tabs	Live assumptions, adjustable sliders, dynamic visuals, and multi-scenario comparison.
Stage 4	Risk Intelligence Platform	Model-driven recommendations, risk scoring, narrative explanations, and advisor workflow automation.

10. Intelligent Recommendations

- Make Disability Insurance the flagship differentiator. DI is nuanced, underserved visually, and closely aligned with your involvement.

- Keep the MVP narrow. Life insurance can prove the calculation and visualization pattern; DI can become the premium module.
- Avoid building a full financial planning suite. The strongest niche is risk comprehension, not all-in-one planning.
- Build outputs as client meeting artifacts first and dashboards second. The advisor needs persuasive clarity across the table.
- Use plain-language assumptions. Clients must understand what is being modeled and what is merely illustrative.
- Design with compliance discipline from the start. Avoid guarantees, deterministic claims, or product-specific advice until the proper review layer exists.

Final summary

NorthStar is a focused risk-management visualization tool that helps advisors show clients the financial gap created by death, disability, unemployment, or liability events. The platform's value is not in replacing advisors or planning software. Its value is making invisible risk visible before solutions are implemented.